

Day 31 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Fundamental Rights II: Religion, Cultural/Educational Rights, and Constitutional Remedies

READING MATERIAL

Covers the final three Fundamental Rights categories (Articles 25-32): Freedom of Religion, Cultural and Educational Rights, and the Right to Constitutional Remedies — the enforcement mechanism for ALL Fundamental Rights. Real exam evidence shows a recurring trap of swapping Article ranges between 'Freedom' (19-22), 'Religion' (25-28), and 'Cultural/Educational Rights' (29-30) — and a writs-meaning matching format for Article 32's remedies.

Q: Real exam: What is the correct Article range for the Right to Freedom of Religion, and what is the common labeling trap?

A: Articles 25-28 — confirmed by elimination in a real exam question that wrongly labeled this exact range (25-28) as belonging to 'Right to Freedom' instead (Right to Freedom is actually Articles 19-22). Don't confuse the two categories just because both contain the word 'Freedom'.

Q: What does each Article in the Freedom of Religion cluster (25-28) cover?

A: Article 25: freedom of conscience and free profession, practice, and propagation of religion. Article 26: freedom to manage religious affairs (for religious denominations). Article 27: freedom from being compelled to pay taxes for promotion of any particular religion. Article 28: freedom from religious instruction in educational institutions wholly maintained by State funds.

Q: Real exam: What is the correct Article range for Cultural and Educational Rights, and what is the common labeling trap?

A: Articles 29-30 — confirmed by elimination in the same real exam question, which wrongly labeled '25-26' as this category's range (25-26 is actually split across Religion's Article 25 and Equality's Article 26 — neither belongs to Cultural/Educational Rights).

Q: What do Articles 29 and 30 specifically protect?

A: Article 29: protects the right of any citizen group with a distinct language, script, or culture to conserve it. Article 30: gives all minorities (religious or linguistic) the right to establish and administer educational institutions of their choice.

Q: What is the Right to Constitutional Remedies, which Article guarantees it, and why is it considered uniquely important?

A: Article 32 — it guarantees the right to move the Supreme Court directly for the enforcement of any Fundamental Right. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar famously called Article 32 the 'heart and soul' of the Constitution, stating the Constitution would be a 'nullity' without it, since it's the actual ENFORCEMENT mechanism for every other Fundamental Right — rights without a remedy would be meaningless.

Q: Real exam: Match each writ to its literal meaning — Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Certiorari, Quo Warranto.

A: Habeas Corpus = 'To have the body of'. Mandamus = 'We command'. Certiorari = 'To be certified'. Quo Warranto = 'By what authority' — all four confirmed via a real exam's match-the-following question.

Q: What is the FUNCTION (not just literal meaning) of each of the five writs the Supreme Court/High Courts can issue?

A: Habeas Corpus: secures release of a person unlawfully detained. Mandamus: directs a public official/body/lower court to perform a duty they've refused to do. Prohibition: stops a lower court from exceeding its jurisdiction (issued BEFORE judgment). Certiorari: quashes/re-examines a lower court's decision (issued AFTER judgment, e.g. for natural-justice violations). Quo Warranto: questions the legal authority of a person holding a public office.

Q: Is the Supreme Court the only court that can issue these writs?

A: No — Article 32 empowers the SUPREME COURT to issue writs specifically for Fundamental Rights enforcement, while Article 226 separately empowers every HIGH COURT to issue the same five writs for enforcement of Fundamental Rights AND for any other legal right — making the High Courts' writ jurisdiction under Article 226 broader in scope than the Supreme Court's under Article 32.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Right to Freedom of Religion is covered under which Articles?

- A. Articles 19-22
- B. Articles 23-24
- C. Articles 25-28 ✓**
- D. Articles 29-30

Explanation: Articles 25-28. [medium, question-bank-2026]

2. Article 27 of the Constitution provides freedom from:

- A. Religious instruction in State-funded schools
- B. Being taxed to promote a particular religion ✓**
- C. Managing one's own religious affairs
- D. Practising any religion

Explanation: Freedom from taxation to promote a particular religion. [medium, authored]

3. Cultural and Educational Rights are covered under which Articles?

- A. Articles 14-18
- B. Articles 25-26
- C. Articles 25-28
- D. Articles 29-30 ✓**

Explanation: Articles 29-30. [medium, question-bank-2026]

4. Article 30 of the Constitution gives minorities the right to:

- A. Reserve seats in Parliament
- B. Establish and administer educational institutions of their choice ✓**
- C. Exemption from all taxes
- D. Form their own political party

Explanation: Establish and administer educational institutions of their choice. [medium, web-research]

5. Which Article guarantees the Right to Constitutional Remedies, famously called the 'heart and soul' of the Constitution by Dr. Ambedkar?

- A. Article 21
- B. Article 30
- C. Article 32 ✓**
- D. Article 368

Explanation: Article 32. [easy, web-research]

6. Match the writ to its literal meaning: Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Certiorari, Quo Warranto — with: 'To have the body of', 'We command', 'To be certified', 'By what authority'.

- A. Habeas Corpus=We command; Mandamus=To have the body of; Certiorari=By what authority; Quo Warranto=To be certified
- B. Habeas Corpus=To have the body of; Mandamus=We command; Certiorari=To be certified; Quo Warranto=By what authority ✓**
- C. Habeas Corpus=By what authority; Mandamus=To be certified; Certiorari=We command; Quo Warranto=To have the body of
- D. Habeas Corpus=To be certified; Mandamus=By what authority; Certiorari=To have the body of; Quo Warranto=We command

Explanation: Habeas Corpus='to have the body of', Mandamus='we command', Certiorari='to be certified', Quo Warranto='by what authority'. [hard, question-bank-2025]

7. Which writ is issued to stop a lower court from exceeding its jurisdiction, BEFORE it delivers judgment?

- A. Mandamus
- B. Prohibition ✓**
- C. Certiorari
- D. Quo Warranto

Explanation: Prohibition. [medium, web-research]

8. Which writ questions the legal authority of a person holding a public office?

- A. Habeas Corpus
- B. Mandamus
- C. Certiorari
- D. Quo Warranto ✓**

Explanation: Quo Warranto. [medium, web-research]

9. Besides the Supreme Court under Article 32, which other constitutional body can issue the same five writs, and under which Article?

- A. The Election Commission, under Article 324
- B. Every High Court, under Article 226 ✓**
- C. The President, under Article 123
- D. The CAG, under Article 148

Explanation: Every High Court, under Article 226 (with broader scope than Article 32). [hard, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Alphanumeric Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Alphanumeric Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, combining letters and numbers in a single pattern. Real exam evidence (independently re-verified) shows three core techniques: letter-to-number position coding, variable-gap letter sequences, and fixed-shift word ciphers.

Q: Method — letter-to-number position coding: If ACEG is coded as 16, and DFGH is coded as 25, how would HIKM be coded?

A: Each letter is converted to its position in the alphabet (A=1, B=2, ... Z=26) and summed. ACEG: A=1, C=3, E=5, G=7, sum=16 ✓. DFGH: D=4, F=6, G=7, H=8, sum=25 ✓. Applying the same rule to HIKM: H=8, I=9, K=11, M=13, sum=8+9+11+13=41.

Q: Method — widening-gap letter sequence: Find the next letter: B, E, I, N, ?

A: Check the gaps between consecutive letters' positions: B(2)→E(5) is +3, E(5)→I(9) is +4, I(9)→N(14) is +5. The gap itself increases by 1 each time, so the next gap is +6: N(14)+6=20, which is T.

Q: Method — fixed-shift word coding (Caesar-cipher style): If ROAD is coded as URDG, how would SWAN be coded using the same rule?

A: Check the shift for each letter: R→U is +3, O→R is +3, A→D is +3, D→G is +3 — a uniform +3 shift applied to every letter. Applying the same +3 shift to SWAN: S→V, W→Z, A→D, N→Q, giving VZDQ.

Q: Method — two-interleaved-sequences letter pair: A pattern alternates first-letters increasing by a fixed gap and second-letters decreasing by the same gap (e.g., AZ, GT, MN, ?, YB). How do you solve it?

A: Track the two positions (first letter, second letter) as SEPARATE sequences. First letters: A(1), G(7), M(13) — increasing by 6 each time, so next is 19=S, then 25=Y (matches the given final term Y). Second letters: Z(26), T(20), N(14) — decreasing by 6 each time, so next is 8=H, then 2=B (matches the given final term B). So the missing term is S+H = 'SH'.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If BDFH is coded as 20 (sum of letter positions), what would CEGI be coded as using the same rule?

- A. 22
- B. 24 ✓**
- C. 26
- D. 28

Explanation: C=3, E=5, G=7, I=9, sum=24. (Check rule: B=2, D=4, F=6, H=8, sum=20 ✓ matches given.) [medium, authored]

2. Find the next letter in the sequence: C, F, J, O, ?

- A. S
- B. T
- C. U ✓**
- D. V

Explanation: Gaps: C(3)→F(6) is +3, F(6)→J(10) is +4, J(10)→O(15) is +5, so next gap is +6: O(15)+6=21=U. [medium, authored]

3. If PLAN is coded as SODQ using a fixed letter shift, how would TRIM be coded using the same rule?

- A. WULP ✓**
- B. WUKP
- C. VULP
- D. WULO

Explanation: Shift check: P→S, L→O, A→D, N→Q — a uniform +3 shift. Applying +3 to TRIM: T→W, R→U, I→L, M→P, giving WULP. [hard, authored]

4. In the sequence DY, IT, NO, ?, XE, the first letters increase and second letters decrease by a fixed gap. What is the missing term?

- A. SJ ✓**
- B. SI
- C. TJ
- D. RJ

Explanation: First letters: D(4), I(9), N(14) — gap +5, so next is 19=S, then 24=X (matches given X). Second letters: Y(25), T(20), O(15) — gap -5, so next is 10=J, then 5=E (matches given E). Missing term: SJ. [hard, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "The Attic" — Satyajit Ray

READING MATERIAL

A first-person short story by Satyajit Ray (better known as a filmmaker) about Aditya, the narrator's friend and business partner, who revisits his ancestral hometown of Brahmapur after many years and finally confesses to a childhood theft — taking a medal belonging to a boy named Sasanka Sanyal — that has weighed on his conscience for 29 years.

Q: Who wrote "The Attic", and what is the central theme of the story?

A: Satyajit Ray. Central theme: human flaws, guilt, and the power of confession/forgiveness — Aditya finally confesses to a childhood theft that has burdened his conscience for decades.

Q: What was Aditya's relationship to the narrator, and what was his ancestral hometown?

A: Aditya was the narrator's friend and business partner; together they had newly started a factory in Deodarganj. Aditya's ancestral hometown (which they revisit during the story) was Brahmapur.

Q: What had Aditya done 29 years earlier that he finally confesses to, and who was the victim?

A: As a child, Aditya had stolen a medal — a 'Special Prize for Recitation' (engraved 'Sriman Sasanka Sanyal — Special Prize for Recitation — 1948') — belonging to a boy named Sasanka Sanyal, and had hidden it in the attic of his ancestral house. He confesses this theft to Sanyal after 29 years, and the medal is finally restored to its rightful owner.

Q: What was special about the attic, and what objects from childhood were found there?

A: The attic was Aditya's favourite childhood place, a private world of his own (a common motif — attics being favoured spaces for children's imagination). Among the objects found there were a broken cricket bat, the remains of an armchair, and a wooden packing case.

Q: What other factual details about the setting does the story establish — the house's age, the season of the visit, and a notable nearby landmark?

A: Aditya's ancestral house was about 200 years old. The visit took place in the Bengali month of Maha (January/February). Opposite the tea shop in the town (owned by 'Nagen Uncle') stood a Shiva temple.

Q: What was Aditya's father's occupation?

A: He was a landlord.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Attic" was written by:

- A. R.K. Narayan
- B. Rabindranath Tagore
- C. Satyajit Ray ✓**
- D. Mulk Raj Anand

Explanation: Satyajit Ray. [easy, web-research]

2. Aditya's ancestral hometown, which he revisits in the story, was:

- A. Brahmapur ✓**
- B. Deodarganj
- C. Kolkata
- D. Delhi

Explanation: Brahmapur. [medium, web-research]

3. What had Aditya done 29 years earlier that he finally confesses to in the story?

- A. Fought with a friend
- B. Stolen a book
- C. Stolen someone's medal ✓**
- D. Run away from school

Explanation: He had stolen Sasanka Sanyal's recitation medal. [medium, web-research]

4. Who was the rightful owner of the medal that Aditya had stolen and hidden in the attic?

- A. Nagen Uncle

B. Sasanka Sanyal ✓

C. Jogesh Kabiraj

D. Aditya's own brother

Explanation: Sasanka Sanyal. [medium, web-research]

5. Aditya's ancestral house, where the attic was located, was approximately how old?

A. 50 years

B. 100 years

C. 200 years ✓

D. 300 years

Explanation: About 200 years. [medium, web-research]

6. During which season/month did Aditya and the narrator's visit to Brahmapur take place?

A. Summer

B. Maha (January/February) ✓

C. Monsoon

D. Autumn

Explanation: Maha (Jan/Feb). [hard, web-research]

7. What stood opposite the tea shop in the town?

A. A school

B. A bank

C. A hospital

D. A Shiva temple ✓

Explanation: A Shiva temple. [medium, web-research]

8. The tea shop in the town was owned by:

A. Sanyal

B. Kabiraj

C. Nagen Uncle ✓

D. Aditya's uncle

Explanation: Nagen Uncle. [medium, web-research]

9. What was Aditya's favourite childhood place in his ancestral house?

A. The library

B. The attic ✓

C. The garden

D. The kitchen

Explanation: The attic. [easy, web-research]

10. Aditya's father's occupation was:

A. Teacher

B. Landlord ✓

C. Police officer

D. Priest

Explanation: Landlord. [medium, web-research]